

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

# New Line Activation Process

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

|                |                                 |
|----------------|---------------------------------|
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| Department     | Retail Operations               |
| Company        | Aether Wireless                 |
| Classification | Internal — Training & Reference |

## Overview

This document outlines the end-to-end process for activating new lines on the Aether Wireless network, covering identity verification, credit checks, SIM and eSIM provisioning, activation workflows, fees, and first-bill expectations. These procedures apply to all retail locations and customer care channels across the United States.

## Pre-Approval Steps

Before any line activation proceeds, the following steps must be completed in order:

- Identity Verification** – Customer provides valid government-issued ID and proof of address
- Credit Check** – Conducted if the customer is financing a device or on a postpaid plan; not required for prepaid
- KYC Consent** – Customer acknowledges and agrees to Know Your Customer requirements
- Plan and Device Selection** – Customer chooses their rate plan and, if applicable, device
- Terms Acceptance** – Customer reviews and accepts the Terms of Service and Service Agreement
- Activation Fee Payment** – One-time activation fee applies per line (see Activation Fees table below)

## Identity Verification

Customers must present documentation to verify their identity and residential address. The following table specifies acceptable documents and validity periods.

| Document Type      | Requirement                                             | Validity                              |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Primary ID         | Passport, Driver's License, National ID, or Military ID | Must be current (not expired)         |
| Proof of Address   | Utility bill, Bank statement, or Lease agreement        | Must be dated within the last 90 days |
| In-Store Biometric | Fingerprint or facial recognition scan                  | Optional in retail locations          |

| Document Type             | Requirement                             | Validity                                      |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Online Video Verification | Live video call with verification agent | Must be completed within 1 hour of initiation |

For online activations, video verification serves as an alternative to in-store document submission. Customers must have their ID ready and be able to clearly display the document during the video call.

## Credit Check

A credit check is required for customers seeking postpaid service or financing a device. The type of inquiry depends on the customer's service choice.

| Service Type                            | Credit Pull Type | Score Impact                | Deposit Required                 |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) – Postpaid | Soft pull        | No impact                   | None                             |
| Financed Device                         | Hard pull        | May temporarily lower score | \$100–\$500 based on credit tier |
| Prepaid Service                         | None             | N/A                         | None                             |

### Key Rules:

- Credit check results are valid for 30 days from the pull date
- If more than 30 days pass, a new credit check is required before activation
- Deposits are refundable upon account closure in good standing
- Customers with no credit history may be approved for prepaid service as an alternative

## SIM and eSIM Provisioning

Aether Wireless supports both physical SIM cards and eSIM technology. The provisioning method depends on customer preference and device compatibility.

### Physical SIM Cards

- **In-Store Activation:** Customer receives the SIM card immediately upon completion of verification
- **Shipped SIM:** Orders placed online or by phone ship within 2 business days at no additional cost

### eSIM Provisioning

- **QR Code Delivery:** eSIM profile delivered via QR code within minutes of activation
- **Compatible Devices:** iPhone XS and newer, Galaxy S20 and newer, Pixel 3 and newer
- **Dual-SIM Support:** Devices with dual-SIM capability can hold both a physical SIM and eSIM simultaneously
- **Remote Provisioning:** Customers can complete eSIM setup through the Aether Wireless app without visiting a store

Staff should verify device compatibility before recommending eSIM activation.

## Activation Flow

The following steps occur in sequence when a new line is activated:

1. **Account Created** – Customer account is established in the system with billing information
2. **SIM Provisioned** – The selected SIM or eSIM is provisioned to the network
3. **Welcome SMS** – Automated welcome message sent to the new line within 2 minutes of activation
4. **Welcome Email** – Confirmation email sent to the customer's registered email address with account details
5. **Prorated First Bill** – First billing cycle includes prorated charges from the activation date to the end of the current billing cycle
6. **14-Day Return Window** – Customer may return the device or cancel service within 14 days for a full refund, subject to the Return Policy terms

## Activation Fees

Activation fees apply to each new line activated. Fees vary by rate plan.

| Rate Plan Tier | Activation Fee | Waiver Conditions                                          |
|----------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Essential      | \$35           | Waived for customers porting a number from another carrier |
| Standard       | \$35           | Waived for customers porting a number from another carrier |
| Premium+       | \$0            | No fee assessed                                            |

All new lines on Premium+ plans are assessed a \$0 activation fee regardless of porting status.

## First-Bill Expectations

The first bill for a new line includes several components. Customers should expect the following:

- **Prorated Charges** – Service charges from the activation date through the end of the first billing cycle
- **Full-Month Charges** – Advance charges for the next full billing cycle
- **Applicable Taxes** – State, federal, and local taxes based on the service address
- **Activation Fee** – One-time fee per line (unless waived)
- **Device Installment** – Monthly payments if the customer purchased a device on an installment plan
- **Protection Plans** – Optional device protection or insurance fees, if selected
- **Promotional Credits** – Any applicable promo credits applied to the account

Customers who activate mid-cycle will see both prorated charges for the partial first month and advance charges for the following month on their initial statement.

## Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Customers may bring their own compatible devices to activate on the Aether Wireless network. The following requirements apply:

- **Device Must Be Unlocked** – The device cannot be locked to another carrier's network
- **Band Compatibility** – Device must support the frequency bands used by Aether Wireless

- **IMEI Check** – Staff must verify the IMEI is clean and not reported lost, stolen, or blocked
- **\$50 Account Credit** – Customers who activate a new line with a qualified BYOD device receive a one-time \$50 credit applied to their account

To check eligibility, enter the device IMEI into the Aether Wireless activation portal or verify through the retail system.

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## FAQs

### **Q: What ID documents are accepted for identity verification?**

**A:** Accepted forms of primary ID include a current (unexpired) passport, driver's license, national ID, or military ID. Proof of address requires a utility bill, bank statement, or lease agreement dated within the last 90 days.

### **Q: Does a credit check affect my credit score?**

**A:** It depends on the service type. A soft pull is used for BYOD postpaid activations and has no impact on the credit score. A hard pull is required for financed devices and may temporarily lower the score. No credit check is performed for prepaid service.

### **Q: How long does eSIM provisioning take?**

**A:** eSIM provisioning via QR code is completed within minutes of activation. The customer simply scans the QR code provided, and the eSIM profile is downloaded directly to the device.

### **Q: What is the deposit requirement for financed devices?**

**A:** Deposits range from \$100 to \$500 depending on the customer's credit tier. The deposit is refundable when the account is closed in good standing.

### **Q: When will I receive my welcome SMS after activation?**

**A:** The welcome SMS is automatically sent to the new line within 2 minutes of successful activation.

### **Q: What does my first bill include?**

**A:** The first bill includes prorated charges from activation to the end of the billing cycle, full-month advance charges, applicable taxes, the activation fee (unless waived), any device installment payments, optional protection plan fees, and any promotional credits.

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*For additional assistance, contact Aether Wireless Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER-1 or visit your nearest retail location.*